

Chapter 5 • Motivation and Affect

Chapter Objectives

When you finish reading this chapter you will understand why:

- 5-1** Products can satisfy a range of consumer needs.
- 5-2** Consumers experience different kinds of motivational conflicts that can impact their purchase decisions.
- 5-3** Consumers experience a range of affective responses to products and marketing messages.
- 5-4** The way we evaluate and choose a product depends on our **degree** of involvement with the product, the marketing message, or the purchase situation.



Source: Phil Date/Shutterstock.

As Basil scans the menu at the trendy health-food restaurant Paula has dragged him to, he reflects on what a man will give up for love. Now that Paula has become a die-hard vegan, she's slowly but surely working on him to forsake those juicy steaks and burgers for healthier fare. He can't even hide from tofu and other delights at school; the dining facility in his dorm just started to offer "veggie" alternatives to its usual assortment of greasy "mystery meats" and other delicacies he loves.

Paula is totally into it; she claims that eating this way not only cuts out unwanted fat but also is good for the environment. Just his luck to fall head-over-heels for a "tree-hugger." As Basil gamely tries to decide between the stuffed artichokes with red pepper vinaigrette and the grilled marinated zucchini, fantasies of a sizzling 14-ounce T-bone dance before his eyes.

OBJECTIVE 5-1

Products can satisfy a range of consumer needs.

The Motivation Process: Why Ask Why?

Paula certainly is not alone in her belief that eating green is good for the body, the soul, and the planet. According to a 2014 Harris Interactive study, approximately 5 percent of U.S. Americans are vegetarian (close to 16 million people) and about half of these vegetarians are vegan. Indeed the number of vegans in the United States has doubled since 2009.

Vegetarianism refers only to a diet that excludes meat (some animal products that do not involve the death of an animal, such as milk, cheese, and butter, may be included). *Veganism*, in contrast, links to a set of ethical beliefs about use of and cruelty to animals. In addition

to objecting to hunting or fishing, adherents protest cruel animal training; object to the degrading use of animals in circuses, zoos, rodeos, and races; and also oppose the testing of drugs and cosmetics on animals.¹

The forces that drive people to buy and use products are generally straightforward—for example, when a person chooses what to have for lunch. As hard-core vegans demonstrate, however, even the basic food products we consume also relate to wide-ranging beliefs regarding what we think is appropriate or desirable. In some cases, these emotional responses create a deep commitment to the product. Sometimes people are not even fully aware of the forces that drive them toward some products and away from others.

To understand motivation is to understand *why* consumers do what they do. Why do some people choose to bungee-jump off a bridge or compete on reality shows, whereas others spend their leisure time playing chess or gardening? Whether it is to quench a thirst, kill boredom, or attain some deep spiritual experience, we do everything for a reason, even if we can't articulate what that reason is. We teach marketing students from Day 1 that the goal of marketing is to satisfy consumers' needs. However, this insight is useless unless we can discover what those needs are and why they exist. A beer commercial once asked, "Why ask why?" In this chapter, we'll find out.

Motivation refers to the processes that lead people to behave as they do. It occurs when a need is aroused that the consumer wishes to satisfy. The need creates a state of tension that drives the consumer to attempt to reduce or eliminate it. This need may be *utilitarian* (i.e., a desire to achieve some functional or practical benefit, as when a person loads up on green vegetables for nutritional reasons) or it may be *hedonic* (i.e., an experiential need, involving emotional responses or fantasies as when a person feels "righteous" by eating kale). The desired end state is the consumer's **goal**. Marketers try to create products and services to provide the desired benefits and help the consumer to reduce this tension.

One question that keeps some consumer researchers up at night is whether a person even needs to be aware of a motivation to achieve a goal. The evidence suggests that motives can lurk beneath the surface, and cues in the environment can activate a goal even when we don't know it: Marketers are just beginning to explore the effects of **incidental brand exposure**:

- People who were exposed to a sign in a room of the brand name "Apple" provided responses on an unrelated task that were more unique compared to those who saw a sign with the IBM brand name.²
- College students who used a "cute" ice cream scoop to help themselves to ice cream took a larger amount than those who used a plain scoop; the researchers explained that the whimsical object drove them to be more self-indulgent even though they weren't aware of this effect.³
- Some students scored higher on difficult Graduate Records Examination questions when they took the test using a Massachusetts Institute of Technology pen and delivered a better athletic performance when they drank water from a Gatorade cup during strenuous exercise.⁴

Motivational Strength

Whether the need is utilitarian or hedonic, the magnitude of the tension it creates determines the urgency the consumer feels to reduce it. We call this degree of arousal a **drive**.

Drive Theory

Drive theory focuses on biological needs that produce unpleasant states of arousal (e.g., your stomach grumbles during a morning class). The arousal this tension causes motivates us to reduce it and return to a balanced state called **homeostasis**. Some researchers believe that this need to reduce arousal is a basic mechanism that governs much of our behavior. Indeed there is research evidence for the effectiveness of so-called **retail therapy**; apparently the act of shopping restores a sense of personal control over one's environment and as a result can alleviate feelings of sadness.⁵ Go for it!

If a behavior reduces the drive, we naturally tend to repeat it. Your motivation to leave class early to grab a snack would be greater if you hadn't eaten in 24 hours than if you had eaten only two hours earlier. If you did sneak out and got indigestion afterward, say, from wolfing down a package of Twinkies, you would be less likely to repeat this behavior the next time you want a snack. One's degree of motivation, then, depends on the distance between one's present state and the goal.

Drive theory runs into difficulties when it tries to explain some facets of human behavior that run counter to its predictions. People often do things that increase a drive state rather than decrease it. For example, we may *delay gratification*. If you know you are going out for a lavish dinner, you might decide to forego a snack earlier in the day even though you are hungry at that time.

Expectancy Theory

Most current explanations of motivation focus on cognitive factors rather than biological ones to understand what motivates behavior. **Expectancy theory** suggests that expectations of achieving desirable outcomes—positive incentives—rather than being pushed from within motivate our behavior. We choose one product over another because we expect this choice to have more positive consequences for us. Thus, we use the term *drive* here loosely to refer to both physical and cognitive processes.

Motivational Direction

Motives have direction as well as strength. They are goal-oriented in that they drive us to satisfy a specific need. We can reach most goals by a number of routes, and the objective of a company is to convince consumers that the alternative it offers provides the best chance to attain the goal. For example, a consumer who decides that she needs a pair of jeans to help her reach her goal of being admired by others can choose among Levi's, Wranglers, True Religion, Diesel, 7 for All Mankind, and many other alternatives, each of which promises to deliver certain benefits.

Needs versus Wants

As we saw in Chapter 1, a *need* reflects a basic goal such as keeping yourself nourished or protected from the elements. In contrast a *want* is a specific pathway to achieving this objective that depends a lot on our unique personalities, cultural upbringing, and our observations about how others we know satisfy the same need. One person's cool

A want (like fast food) is a specific way to satisfy a need (like hunger).

Source: Dennis Tarnay, Jr./Alamy.





For some, jumping out of an airplane is a valuable hedonic experience.

Source: Kovalenko Inna.

downtown loft is another's suburban McMansion. In some cases, we don't even know we have a "want" until we can no longer have it: A lot of people didn't know they wanted *foie gras* ice cream sandwiches until California made them illegal. California banned *foie gras* in 2012, arguing that it was cruel to force-feed a duck to fatten its liver. Demand for delicacies made with the expensive and unobtainable dish spiked. A federal court overturned the ban in 2015, much to the relief of fatty liver connoisseurs.⁶

When we focus on a *utilitarian need*, we emphasize the objective, tangible attributes of products, such as miles per gallon in a car; the amount of fat, calories, and protein in a cheeseburger; or the durability of a pair of blue jeans. *Hedonic needs* are subjective and experiential; here we might look to a product to meet our needs for excitement, self-confidence, or fantasy—perhaps to escape the mundane or routine aspects of life.⁷ Many items satisfy our hedonic needs (there's even a popular resort called Hedonism). Luxury brands in particular thrive when they offer the promise of pleasure to the user—how badly do you "need" that Armani suit or Coach bag?⁸

Of course, we can also be motivated to purchase a product because it provides *both* types of benefits. For example, a woman (perhaps a politically incorrect one) might buy a mink coat because of the luxurious image it portrays and because it also happens to keep her warm through the long, cold winter. Indeed, recent research on novel consumption experiences indicates that even when we choose to do unusual things (like eating bacon ice cream or staying in a freezing ice hotel), we may do so because we have what the authors term a **productivity orientation**. This refers to a continual striving to use time constructively: Trying new things is a way to check them off our "bucket list" of experiences we want to achieve before we move on to others.⁹

OBJECTIVE 5-2

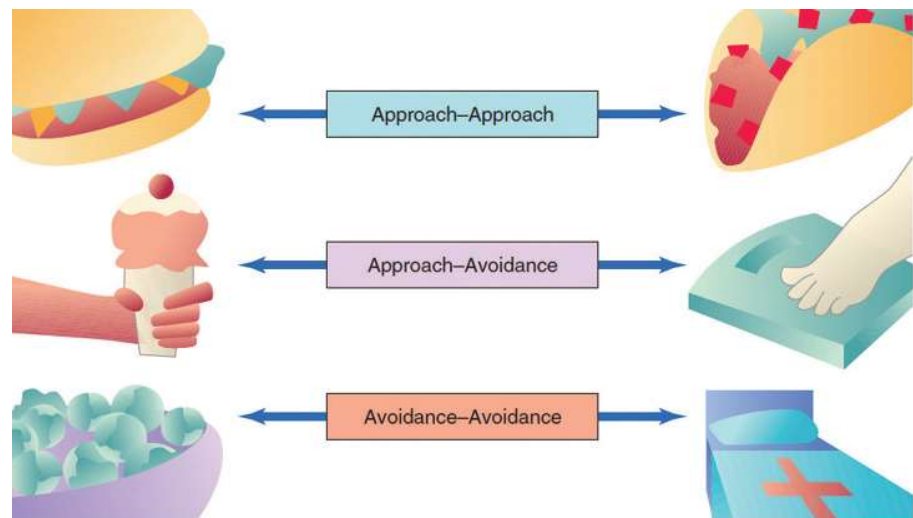
Consumers experience different kinds of motivational conflicts that can impact their purchase decisions.

Motivational Conflicts

A goal has *valence*, which means that it can be positive or negative. We direct our behavior toward goals we value positively; we are motivated to *approach* the goal and to seek out products that will help us to reach it. However, as we saw in Chapter 4's discussion of negative reinforcement, sometimes we're also motivated to *avoid* a negative outcome rather than achieve a positive outcome.

We structure purchases or consumption activities to reduce the chances that we will experience a nasty result. For example, many consumers work hard to avoid rejection by their peers (an avoidance goal). They stay away from products that

Figure 5.1 TYPES OF MOTIVATIONAL CONFLICT



they associate with social disapproval. Products such as deodorants and mouthwash frequently rely on consumers' negative motivation when ads depict the onerous social consequences of underarm odor or bad breath.

Because a purchase decision can involve more than one source of motivation, consumers often find themselves in situations in which different motives, both positive and negative, conflict with one another.¹⁰ Marketers attempt to satisfy consumers' needs by providing possible solutions to these dilemmas. As Figure 5.1 shows, there are three general types of conflicts we should understand.

Approach-Approach Conflict

A person has an **approach-approach conflict** when he or she must choose between two desirable alternatives. A student might be torn between going home for the holidays and going on a skiing trip with friends. Or, he or she might have to choose between two CDs to download (assuming that he or she is going to pay for one of them!). The **theory of cognitive dissonance** is based on the premise that people have a need for order and consistency in their lives and that a state of *dissonance* (tension) exists when beliefs or behaviors conflict with one another. We resolve the conflict that arises when we choose between two alternatives through a process of *cognitive dissonance reduction*, where we look for a way to reduce this inconsistency (or dissonance) and thus eliminate unpleasant tension.

Postdecision dissonance occurs when a consumer must choose between two products, both of which possess good and bad qualities. When he or she chooses one product and not the other, the person gets the bad qualities of the product he or she buys and loses out on the good qualities of the one he or she didn't buy. This loss creates an unpleasant, dissonant state that he wants to reduce. We tend to convince ourselves, after the fact, that the choice we made was the smart one as we find additional reasons to support the alternative we did choose—perhaps when we discover flaws with the option we did not choose (sometimes we call this *rationalization*). A marketer can bundle several benefits together to resolve an approach-approach conflict. For example, Miller Lite's claim that it is "less filling" and "tastes great" allows the drinker to "have his beer and drink it too."

Approach-Avoidance Conflict

Many of the products and services we desire have negative consequences attached to them as well as positive ones. We may feel guilty or ostentatious when we buy a luxury product such as a fur coat or we might feel like gluttons when we crave a tempting package of Twinkies. An **approach-avoidance conflict** occurs when we desire a goal but wish to avoid it at the same time.

Some solutions to these conflicts include the proliferation of fake furs, which eliminate guilt about harming animals to make a fashion statement, and the success of diet programs like Weight Watchers that promise good food without the calories.¹¹ Many

marketers try to help consumers overcome guilt by convincing them that they deserve these luxuries. As the model for L'Oréal cosmetics exclaims, "Because I'm worth it!"

Avoidance-Avoidance Conflict

Sometimes we find ourselves caught "between a rock and a hard place." We may face a choice with two undesirable alternatives: for instance, the option of either spending more money on an old car or buying a new one. Don't you hate when that happens? Marketers frequently address an **avoidance-avoidance conflict** with messages that stress the unforeseen benefits of choosing one option (e.g., when they emphasize special credit plans to ease the pain of car payments).

How We Classify Consumer Needs

Numerous psychologists have tried to define a universal inventory of needs they could trace systematically to explain virtually all behavior.

Murray's Psychogenic Needs

One such inventory that the psychologist Henry Murray developed delineates a set of 20 *psychogenic needs* that (sometimes in combination) result in specific behaviors. These needs include such dimensions as *autonomy* (being independent), *defendance* (defending the self against criticism), and even *play* (engaging in pleasurable activities).¹²

Murray's framework is the basis for a number of personality tests that modern-day psychologists use, such as the Thematic Apperception Test (TAT). In the TAT, the analyst shows test subjects four to six ambiguous pictures and asks them to write answers to four direct questions about the pictures:

- 1 What is happening?
- 2 What led up to this situation?
- 3 What is being thought?
- 4 What will happen?

The theory behind the test is that people will freely project their own subconscious needs onto the neutral stimulus. By getting responses to the pictures, the analyst really gets at the person's true needs for achievement or affiliation or whatever other need may be dominant. Murray believed that everyone has the same basic set of needs but that individuals differ in their priority rankings of these needs.¹³

Specific Needs and Buying Behavior

Other motivational approaches have focused on specific needs and their ramifications for behavior. For example, individuals with a high *need for achievement* strongly value personal accomplishment.¹⁴ They place a premium on products and services that signify success because these consumption items provide feedback about the realization of their goals. These consumers are good prospects for products that provide evidence of their achievement. One study of working women found that those who were high in achievement motivation were more likely to choose clothing they considered businesslike and less likely to be interested in apparel that accentuated their femininity.¹⁵ Some other important needs that are relevant to consumer behavior include:

- *Need for affiliation* (to be in the company of other people):¹⁶ The need for affiliation is relevant to products and services for people in groups, such as participating in team sports, frequenting bars, and hanging out at shopping malls.
- *Need for power* (to control one's environment):¹⁷ Many products and services allow us to feel that we have mastery over our surroundings. These products range from "hopped-up" muscle cars and loud boom boxes (oversized portable radios that impose one's musical tastes on others) to luxury resorts that promise to respond to every whim of their pampered guests.

- *Need for uniqueness* (to assert one's individual identity):¹⁸ Products satisfy the need for uniqueness when they pledge to bring out our distinctive qualities. For example, Cachet perfume claims to be “as individual as you are.”

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

The psychologist Abraham Maslow originally developed his influential **Hierarchy of Needs** to understand personal growth and how people attain spiritual “peak experiences.” Marketers later adapted his work to understand consumer motivations.¹⁹ Maslow's *hierarchical* structure implies that the order of development is fixed—that is, we must attain a certain level before we activate a need for the next, higher one. Marketers embraced this perspective because it (indirectly) specifies certain types of product benefits people might look for, depending on their stage of mental or spiritual development or on their economic situation.²⁰

Figure 5.2 presents this model. At each level, the person seeks different kinds of product benefits. Ideally, an individual progresses up the hierarchy until his or her dominant motivation is a focus on “ultimate” goals, such as justice and beauty. Unfortunately, this state is difficult to achieve (at least on a regular basis); most of us have to be satisfied with occasional glimpses, or *peak experiences*. One study of men aged 49 to 60 found that these respondents engaged in three types of activities to attain self-fulfillment: (1) *sport and physical activity*, (2) *community and charity*, and (3) *building and renovating*. Regardless of whether these activities were related to their professional work, these so-called *magnetic points* gradually took the place of those that were not as fulfilling.²¹

Marketers' applications of this hierarchy have been somewhat simplistic, especially because the same product or activity can gratify different needs. For example, one study found that gardening could satisfy needs at every level of the hierarchy:²²

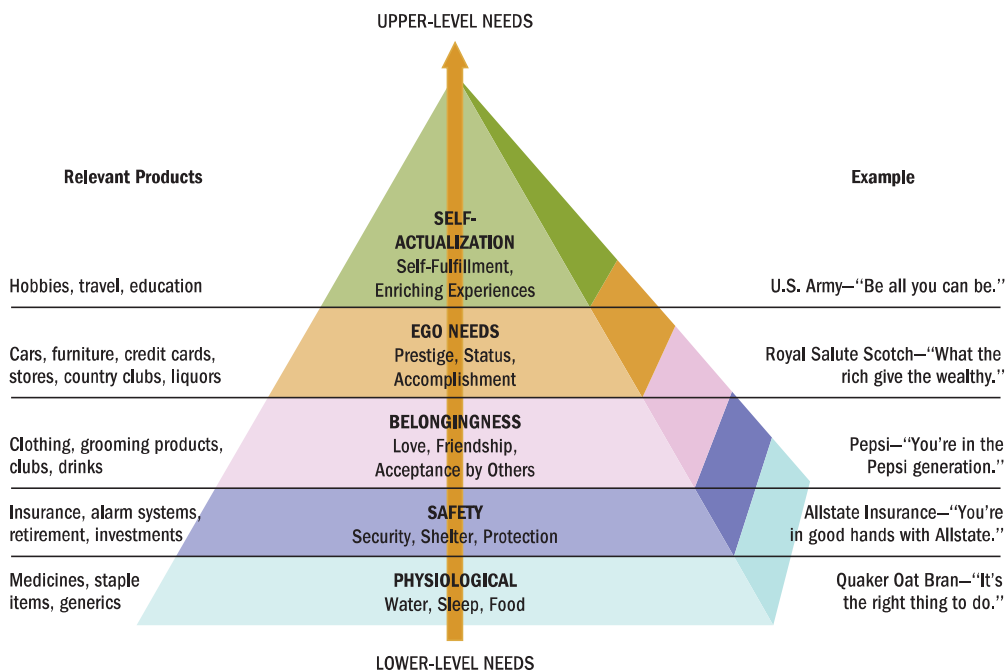
- **Physiological**—“I like to work in the soil.”
- **Safety**—“I feel safe in the garden.”
- **Social**—“I can share my produce with others.”
- **Esteem**—“I can create something of beauty.”
- **Self-actualization**—“My garden gives me a sense of peace.”

Another problem with taking Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs too literally is that it is culture-bound; its assumptions may apply only to Western culture. People in other

Safety is a lower-level need in Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Source: Courtesy of Volvo do Brasil.



Figure 5.2 MASLOW'S HIERARCHY OF NEEDS

cultures (or, for that matter, even some in Western cultures) may question the order of the levels it specifies. A religious person who has taken a vow of celibacy would not necessarily agree that physiological needs must be satisfied before self-fulfillment can occur.

Similarly, many Asian cultures value the welfare of the group (belongingness needs) more highly than needs of the individual (esteem needs). The point is that this hierarchy, although marketers widely apply it, is helpful primarily because it reminds us that consumers may have different need priorities in different consumption situations and at different stages in their lives—not because it *exactly* specifies a consumer's progression up the ladder of needs.



A basic activity like gardening can satisfy people at different levels depending upon their motivation to engage in it.

Source: Todd Arena/123RF.

OBJECTIVE 5-3

Consumers experience a range of affective responses to products and marketing messages.

Affect

Zumba began in the 1990s as a Colombian dance fitness program, but today it's an international sensation. Every week about 14 million people in more than 150 countries take classes that combine elements of dance moves adapted from various sources such as hip-hop, salsa, merengue, mambo, belly dancing and Bollywood, with some squats and lunges thrown in for good measure. The Zumba company started as an infomercial producer, but the regimen was popularized when the CEO's brother, an out-of-work advertising executive, had a revelation and convinced him to change focus. The brother recalls that he saw a movie billboard with some exuberant dancers: "Immediately, I called my brother and said, 'You're selling the wrong thing. You're selling fitness when you should be selling this emotion.' I wanted to turn Zumba into a brand where people felt that kind of free and electrifying joy." The two invented the tagline, "Ditch the workout; join the party!" The rest is history.²³

We may not all be in good enough shape to endure a Zumba workout, but many of our decisions are driven by our emotional responses to products. Social scientists refer to these raw reactions as **affect**. That explains why so many marketing activities and messages focus on altering our moods or linking their products to an affective response, although different types of emotional arousal may be more effective in some contexts than others.²⁴ These connections make sense to anyone who has ever teared up during a sappy TV commercial or written an angry letter after getting shabby treatment at a hotel.

Types of Affective Responses

Affect describes the experience of emotionally laden states, but the nature of these experiences ranges from evaluations, to moods, to full-blown emotions. **Evaluations** are valenced (i.e., positive or negative) reactions to events and objects that are not accompanied by high levels of physiological arousal. For example, when a consumer evaluates a movie as being positive or negative, this usually involves some degree of affect accompanied by low levels of arousal (possible exceptions such as *Fifty Shades of Gray* notwithstanding!). **Moods** involve temporary positive or negative affective states accompanied by moderate levels of arousal. Moods tends to be diffuse and not necessarily linked to a particular event (e.g. you might have just "woken up on the wrong side of the bed this morning"). **Emotions** such as happiness, anger, and fear tend to be more intense and often relate to a specific triggering event such as receiving an awesome gift.²⁵

Marketers find many uses for affective states. They often try to link a product or service with a positive mood or emotion (just think of a sappy Hallmark greeting card). Of

Zumba exercise routines focus on providing an emotional experience.

Source: Photo by Danny Martindale/WireImage/Getty Images.



course a variety of products from alcohol to chocolate are consumed at least partly for their ability to enhance mood. Numerous companies evaluate the emotional impact of their ads; some such as Unilever and Coca-Cola use sophisticated technology that interprets how viewers react to ads by their facial expressions.²⁶

On other occasions marketing communications may deliberately evoke negative affect, such as regret if you forget to play the lottery. Perhaps a more productive way to harness the power of negative affect is to expose the consumer to a distressing image and then provide a way to improve it. For example, a nonprofit organization might run an ad showing a starving child when it solicits donations. Helping others as a way to resolve one's own negative moods is known as **negative state relief**. Recently we've seen a trend in advertising toward inspirational stories that manipulate our emotions like a roller-coaster: Think about the commercials Budweiser likes to run about a puppy who befriends a horse, gets lost, finds his way home, etc. This practice even has a name: **sadvertising**.²⁷

A study shows that this emotional element is especially potent for decisions that involve outcomes the person will experience shortly as opposed to those that involve a longer time frame.²⁸ Another study attests to the interplay between our emotions and how we access information in our minds that allows us to make smarter decisions. These researchers reported evidence for what they call an **emotional oracle effect**: People who trusted their feelings were able to predict future events better than those who did not; this occurred for a range of situations including the presidential election, the winner of *American Idol*, movie box office success, and the stock market. The likely reason is that those with more confidence were better able to access information they had learned that could help them make an informed forecast.²⁹

Mood Congruency

We've already seen that cognitive dissonance occurs when our various feelings, beliefs, or behaviors don't line up, and we may be motivated to alter one or more of these to restore consistency. We'll talk more about that in our discussion of attitudes in Chapter 8.

Mood congruency refers to the idea that our judgments tend to be shaped by our moods. For example, consumers judge the same products more positively when they are in a positive as opposed to a negative mood. This is why advertisers attempt to place their ads after humorous TV programming or create uplifting ad messages that put viewers in a good mood. Similarly, retailers work hard to make shoppers happy by playing "up" background music and encouraging staff to be friendly. Then of course there's the traditional "three-martini" business lunch...

Positive Affect

As part of its global "Open Happiness" campaign, Coca-Cola set up a vending machine at the National University of Singapore that trades free coke beverages for hugs. The machine, which is outfitted in Coca-Cola's signature colors and fonts, reads, "hug me" in large letters on the front.³⁰

Our feelings also can serve as a source of information when we weigh the pros and cons of a decision. Put simply, the fact that the prospect of owning a specific brand will make a person feel good can give it a competitive advantage—even if the brand is similar on a functional level to other competing brands. That helps to explain why many of us will willingly pay a premium for a product that on the surface seems to do the same thing as a less expensive alternative—whether in the case of the hottest new Apple iPhone, a Justice shirt, or even a pricey university. A passionate commitment to one brand has famously been termed a **lovemark** by the head of the Saatchi & Saatchi advertising agency.

Happiness

Happiness is a mental state of well-being characterized by positive emotions. What makes us happy? Although many of us believe owning more shiny material goods is the key to happiness, research says otherwise. Several studies have reported that a greater emphasis on acquiring *things* actually links to lower levels of happiness! Indeed some

CB AS I SEE IT

Michel Tuan Pham, Columbia University



Theories of how consumers make choices and decisions have historically emphasized processes that are cognitive and seemingly “rational.” Consumers, we are told, function a bit like computers: They search and receive product-related information from the environment (e.g., the electrical consumption of a dishwasher), combine this information with other information stored in their memory (e.g., the reputation of a particular brand), and integrate the whole into an overall decision using rules that reflect what consumers care about (e.g.,

their willingness to trade-off brand reputation for lower prices). The metaphor typically advanced is that of a consumer using *Consumer Reports*® to make decisions.

Anyone who has observed consumers operate in the real world knows that the above-described model offers a poor description of many consumption decisions. In particular, this computer-like model doesn’t capture the important role that feelings and emotions play in consumers’ decisions and behavior. Think of the pride and contentment of a mother buying new shoes for her growing toddler, the joy of a young child learning that she is going to Disneyland, the excitement of a teenager planning his next birthday party, or the anger of a customer who feels cheated by a company. How does one capture that?

For the past 25 years, I have studied how feelings and emotions influence consumers’ decisions and behavior. My findings show that feelings and emotions indeed do matter. Part of the reason why they matter is that contrary to the assumed incompatibility between emotion and rationality, consumers typically consider their feelings and emotions to be informative. On this point, I think that they are generally right. If a product doesn’t “feel right,” one should probably stay away from it,

even if it seems like a good deal; and if a product “feels right,” one is likely to be happy with it in the long run—something that I have called *emotional rationality*.

Another reason why feelings and emotions matter is that a lot of the seemingly logical arguments that consumers use to explain their decisions are in fact *post hoc* rationalizations of their immediate feelings toward the products that they evaluate. Consumers may reason that they like a new BMW because it has good mileage or because their current car is getting old, whereas in fact these rationales only came to their minds because they were immediately attracted by the car’s pleasing aesthetic. First emotional impressions thus matter a lot in business.

My research further shows that feelings and emotions are not just good or bad, pleasant or unpleasant. Their specific content makes a big difference. Pride isn’t the same as excitement; anxiety isn’t the same as sadness; and joy isn’t the same as relaxation. Each of these distinct emotions moves consumers in different directions. A big challenge for marketers will be to understand how to induce the “right” emotions among consumers, which is something that I am currently working on in my latest research.

recent evidence suggests we are “wired” to engage in **material accumulation**, which is what researchers term the instinct to earn more than we can possibly consume, even when this imbalance makes us unhappy. In the first phase of a study to explore this idea, respondents were asked to listen to obnoxious white noise on a headset. They were told they could earn pieces of Dove chocolate when they listened to the white noise a certain number of times. They also were asked to estimate how many pieces of chocolate they could eat in a 5-minute period after this phase. Respondents on average endured enough white noise to earn far more chocolates than even they predicted they could eat. In other words, they endured negative experiences to earn more than they knew they could possibly consume.³¹



Happiness is an extreme state of well-being accompanied by positive emotions.

Source: Phil Date/Shutterstock.

Other work suggests that experiences beat out material acquisitions. In one study respondents were asked to think of either a material purchase (defined as a purchase made with the primary intention of acquiring a material possession) or an experiential purchase (defined as a purchase made with the primary intention of acquiring a life experience). Even though the two scenarios were matched for the price paid, respondents were happier when they thought of experiential purchases.³² In addition, the drivers of happiness also seem to vary throughout the life span. Younger people are more likely to associate happiness with excitement, whereas older people are more likely to associate this state with feelings of calm and peacefulness.³³

Negative Affect

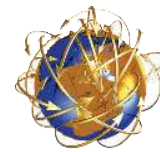
Although we may assume that marketers want to make us happy all the time, that's hardly the case. Marketing messages can make us sad, angry or even depressed—and sometimes that's done on purpose!

Disgust

Many researchers believe that the primitive emotion of disgust evolved to protect us from contamination; we learned over the years to avoid putrid meat and other foul substances linked to pathogens. As a result, even the slight odor of something nasty elicits a universal reaction—the wrinkling of the nose, curling of the upper lips, and protrusion of the tongue. Wrinkling the nose has been shown to prevent pathogens from entering through the nasal cavity, and sticking out the tongue aids in the expulsion of tainted food and is a common precursor to vomiting.

OK, now that you're sufficiently grossed out, what (you may ask in disgust) does this have to do with marketing and persuasion? Well, disgust also exerts a powerful effect on our judgments. People who experience this emotion become harsher in their judgments of moral offenses and offenders. In one experiment, people who sat in a foul-smelling room or at a desk cluttered with dirty food containers judged acts such as lying on a résumé or keeping a wallet found on the street as more immoral than individuals who were asked to make the same judgments in a clean environment. In another study, survey respondents who were randomly asked to complete the items while they stood in front of a hand sanitizer gave more conservative responses than those who stood in another part of the hallway.³⁵

The Tangled Web



The next time you're feeling down and you think about cheering yourself by checking your Facebook page, think again:

Researchers report that the longer people stay on Facebook, the worse they feel. Apparently this activity makes you feel like you're wasting your life; people say that compared to browsing the Internet (or perhaps, studying) Facebook checking is less meaningful or useful. This judgment in turns leads to bad feelings.³⁴

Talk about a rude awakening—and the need to make a quick decision! This unforgiving clock brings new meaning to the phrase, “you snooze, you lose.” If you don’t get up to turn off the alarm when it sounds, it’s going to cost you.

Source: wireframe.ru.



Advertisers used to avoid using negative imagery so they wouldn’t turn people off, but many now realize that it actually can be productive to elicit extreme feelings such as disgust to get their message across:

- To discourage people from consuming sugary drinks, The New York Department of Health showed a man imbibing a soft drink—as he does the beverage turns into gobs of fat.
- Febreze ran a TV commercial where blindfolded people in a foul room believe it’s actually a nice location because the air freshener covers up the stench.
- Lamisil is a medication for toenail fungus, so it’s not too hard to generate feelings of disgust. The company created a creature it called “Digger” that excavates its way under people nails—a safe bet it accomplished its objective.

Envy

Envy is a negative emotion associated with the desire to reduce the gap between oneself and someone who is superior on some dimension. Researchers distinguish between two types of envy: *Benign envy* occurs when we believe the other person actually deserves a coveted brand (like an iPhone). Under these circumstances the person may be willing to pay more to obtain the same item. *Malicious envy* occurs when the consumer believes the other person does not deserve his or her superior position. In this case the consumer may not desire the product the other person owns, but he or she may be willing to pay more for a different brand in the same category (like a Samsung Galaxy) to set them apart from the other person.³⁶

Guilt

Guilt is “an individual’s unpleasant emotional state associated with possible objections to his or her actions, inaction, circumstances, or intentions.”³⁷ Marketers may try to invoke a feeling of guilt when they want consumers to engage in prosocial behaviors like giving to charities. These “guilt appeals” can be particularly effective when others are present because this approach activates a sense of social responsibility. However, extreme guilt appeals can backfire so often a more subtle approach is preferable.³⁸

Embarrassment

Embarrassment is an emotion driven by a concern for what others think about us. To be embarrassed, we must be aware of, and care about, the audience that evaluates us.³⁹ This reaction also pops up in the consumer environment when we purchase socially sensitive products such as condoms, adult diapers, tampons, or hair-lice shampoo.⁴⁰ In these

situations consumers get creative as they try to reduce embarrassment; they might try to hide a sensitive product among others in a shopping basket or choose a cashier who looks “more friendly” when they check out.

How Social Media Tap into Our Emotions

Since 1972, the tiny country of Bhutan has measured the Gross National Happiness of its citizens.⁴¹ Now the city of Somerville, MA, is testing an app called H(app)athon, which combines survey questions about well-being with data collected automatically by phone to monitor how happy residents are. New devices like Fitbits and services like the Nike + Training Club allow many of us to continuously monitor our well-being; at least in terms of steps walked or how well we slept.⁴² Proponents of a **happiness economy** claim that well-being is the new wealth, and social media technology is what allows us to accumulate it.

A lot of our social media activity involves expressing affect, both positive and negative. We may share particularly good or bad feelings on Facebook or Twitter, or even resort to corny emoticons like :) in texts or emails, to convey how we feel. To push sales of its Jell-O brand, Kraft unveiled a “Mood Monitor” on Twitter, in which it will randomly send coupons to users it finds who type in a :(emoticon. Kraft will monitor the Twittersphere and the company will launch coupons whenever the national average of smiley faces dips below 51 percent.⁴³ LOL!

In fact, it’s so common for people to express their moods and also their emotional reactions to products that these posts can be a treasure trove for marketers who want to learn more about how their offerings make people feel. A technique called **sentiment analysis** refers to a process (sometimes also called *opinion mining*) that scours the social media universe to collect and analyze the words people use when they describe a specific product or company. When people feel a particular way, they are likely to choose certain words that tend to relate to the emotion. From these words, the researcher creates a **word-phrase dictionary** (sometimes called a *library*) to code the data. The program scans the text to identify whether the words in the dictionary appear.

Consider this example based on Canon’s PowerShot A540. A review on *Epinions*, a product review site, included this statement: “The Canon PowerShot A540 had good aperture and excellent resolution.” A sentiment analysis would extract the entities of interest from the sentence, identifying the product as the Canon PowerShot A540 and the relevant dimensions as aperture and resolution. The sentiment would then be extracted for each dimension: the sentiment for aperture is *good*, whereas that for resolution is *excellent*. Text-mining software would collect these reactions and combine them with others to paint a picture of how people are talking about the product. There are several sentiment analysis programs that do similar things; a new one called ToneCheck even reports on the emotions it detects in people’s emails.⁴⁵

OBJECTIVE 5-4

The way we evaluate and choose a product depends on our degree of involvement with the product, the marketing message, or the purchase situation.

Consumer Involvement

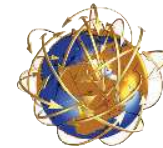
Imagine this conversation between two shoppers at a car dealership:

Consumer #1: I want the one I read about in the latest issue of *Car and Driver* magazine: It has a six-cylinder turbo engine, a double-clutch transmission, a 90 strokebore, and 10:1 compression ratio.

Consumer #2: I want a red one.

Involvement is “a person’s perceived relevance of the object based on their inherent needs, values, and interests.”⁴⁶ Figure 5.3 shows that different factors may create involvement. These factors can be something about the person, something about the object, or something about the situation.

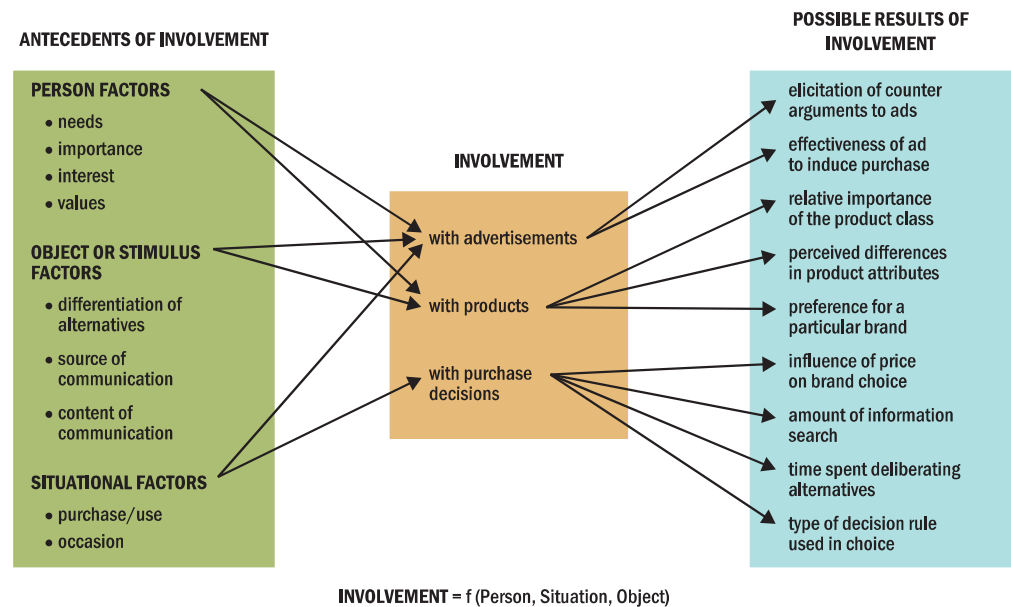
The Tangled Web



Facebook routinely adjusts its users’ news feeds, without their knowledge, to see what happens when they see

different ad formats or numbers of ads. The company got into hot water recently when it admitted that it had manipulated the news feeds of more than 600,000 randomly selected users to change the number of positive and negative posts they saw. The goal was to determine if these posts then influenced what users posted. Sure enough, moods are contagious: people who saw more positive posts responded by writing more positive posts. Similarly, seeing more negative content prompted the viewers to be more negative in their own posts. Although Facebook argued that users give blanket consent to the company’s research as a condition of using the service, many critics suggested the company had crossed an ethical boundary.⁴⁴

Figure 5.3 CONCEPTUALIZING INVOLVEMENT



The level of involvement may be influenced by one or more of these three factors. Interactions among persons, situation, and object factors are likely to occur.

Marketing Opportunity



As we saw in Chapter 4, *gamification* is a red-hot marketing strategy today; it refers to the application of gaming principles to

non-gaming contexts. This approach offers a way to dramatically increase involvement, especially for activities that can benefit from a bit of motivation. When the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC) wanted to promote financial literacy, the government agency created its Money Smart program. It's designed to look like a board game similar to *Monopoly* and it challenges players to learn financial skills such as setting up a bank account, paying bills on time and avoiding identity theft. The game attracted more than 40,000 users in a year.⁵³ Closer to home, when the business school at Syracuse University wanted to ramp up undergraduates' interest in corporate finance, it did so by placing students into one of four "houses" for the year à la *Harry Potter*, each with its own name and shield. Students can earn points for attending optional lectures and other finance-related activities. The winning team at the end of the year gets a party with the Dean, but also a "house cup" just like in the movie.⁵⁴

Our motivation to attain a goal increases our desire to acquire the products or services that we believe will satisfy it. However, as we see in the case of Consumer #2 at the car dealership, not everyone is motivated to the same extent. Involvement reflects our level of motivation to process information about a product or service we believe will help us to solve a problem or reach a goal.⁴⁷ Think of a person's degree of involvement as a continuum that ranges from absolute lack of interest in a marketing stimulus at one end to obsession at the other. **Inertia** describes consumption at the low end of involvement, where we make decisions out of habit because we lack the motivation to consider alternatives. Table 5.1 shows one of the most widely used scales to assess level of involvement.

Depending on whether the need we want to satisfy is utilitarian or hedonic (see Chapter 1), as our involvement increases we think more about the product ("I've spent the last three days researching mortgage interest rates") or we experience a strong emotional response ("I get goose bumps when I imagine what my daughter will look like in that bridal gown").⁴⁸ Not surprisingly, we tend to find higher levels of involvement in product categories that demand a big investment of money (like houses) or self-esteem (like clothing) and lower levels for mundane categories like household cleaners or hardware.⁴⁹ Still, bear in mind that virtually anything can qualify as highly involving to some people—just ask a "tool guy" to talk about his passion for hammers or plumbing supplies.

When Apple put its first iPhone on sale, thousands of adoring iCultists around the country (including the mayor of Philadelphia) waited in front of Apple stores for days to be one of the first to buy the device—even though they could order the phone online and have it delivered in 3 days. Somehow that was too long to wait for a cell phone with a touchscreen. As one loyal consumer admitted, "If Apple made sliced bread, yeah, I'd buy it."⁵⁰

Cult products such as Apple—or Hydrox, Harley-Davidson, Jones Soda, Chick-Fil-A, Manolo Blahnik designer shoes (think Carrie on *Sex and the City*), and the Boston Red Sox—command fierce consumer loyalty, devotion, and maybe even worship by consumers.⁵¹ A large majority of consumers agree that they are willing to pay more for a brand when they feel a personal connection to the company.⁵²

This Brazilian ad for hair-loss product appeals to men who take their impending baldness seriously.

Source: Art Director: Pedro Vargens, Creative Directors: Bruno Richter and Victor Vicente.



Marketing Opportunity



When we have the opportunity to personalize a product, our involvement increases because the item reflects our unique preferences. But how about when we build the product ourselves? Researchers term this the **IKEA Effect**; self-made (or at least assembled) products including furniture, Legos, and even origami enhance the value we attach to them because our own labor is involved.⁶¹ Of course, there may also be that unsettling feeling when you finish assembling a bookcase and there's still one part left over....

consensus is that there are actually several broad types of involvement we can relate to the product, the message, or the perceiver.⁵⁷

Product Involvement

Product involvement is a consumer's level of interest in a particular product. The more closely marketers can tie a brand to an individual, the higher the involvement they will create.

As a rule, product decisions are likely to be highly involving if the consumer believes there is a lot of **perceived risk**. This means the person believes there may be negative consequences if he or she chooses the wrong option. Risk is greater when a product is expensive or complicated. In some cases perceived risk also is a factor when others can see what we choose, and we may be embarrassed if we make the wrong choice.⁵⁸ Remember that a product does not necessarily have to cost a fortune or be hard to use to be risky—for example, a college senior who is going to a job interview may obsess about sweating too much and give a lot of thought to the brand of deodorant he or she uses that morning.



We value things more when our own labor contributes to making or assembling them.

Source: Maridav/Fotolia.

CB AS I SEE IT

Debora Thompson, *Georgetown University*



Companies increasingly involve consumers in the process of developing advertising and other marketing actions. Such **co-creation** of marketing with consumers is expected to significantly increase their engagement with the brand. However, not much is known about the response of consumers who have not been directly involved in the co-creation process, but are simply informed that the company undertook co-creation activity with some unspecified fellow consumers. My research has explored when and why informing the audience that an ad was created by another consumer will increase message

persuasiveness. Through several lab experiments in which consumers watched TV ads for several brands, my colleagues and I have found that informing consumers that an ad is consumer-generated triggers two conflicting responses: skepticism about the competence of the ad creator and identification with the ad creator. Skepticism emerges when the audience challenges the ability of regular consumers to design effective advertising, perhaps recognizing that effective advertising requires particular skill and expertise. Identification emerges when the audience perceives similarities between themselves and the consumer creating the ad. The effectiveness of disclosing advertising co-creation, therefore, depends on factors that hinder skepticism and heighten identification with the ad creator. Interestingly, we found that attributing the ad to a consumer backfires when the ad creator is simply portrayed as an unspecified fellow consumer or when the audience consists of non-loyal consumers who do not share with the ad creator a commitment towards the brand. However, this negative effect can be mitigated and even reversed under high distraction viewing conditions, when consumers' ability to activate their critical thoughts is limited, and when the audience identifies with the

consumer creating the ad, such as when the ad creator is depicted as sharing a background trait with the viewers or when the consumer is loyal to the brand.

Overall, my research shows that although marketers should continue to engage consumers and benefit from their creativity, they should be careful about how they publicize this fact to the population at large. To reap greater benefits from consumer-generated campaigns, it is important to develop a narrative not only about the initiative itself, but also about the consumer creating the ad. Marketers can prevent the heightened skepticism about the skills of ordinary consumers as content creators by increasing identification between the ad creator and the ad recipient. This can be done by disseminating information about the co-creation process via public relations efforts, TV ads, and online videos, or through social networking sites (e.g., developing "the making of the ad" videos). Finally, my research suggests that the disclosure of consumer-generated ads should be driven by a careful assessment of the brand's growth objectives. Consumer-generated advertising campaigns are likely to be a more effective tactic to engage and retain a brand's loyal customers, rather than to attract and grow the share of customers who are not presently loyal to the brand.

Figure 5.4 lists five kinds of risk—including objective (e.g., physical danger) and subjective (e.g., social embarrassment) factors—as well as the products each type tends to affect. Perceived risk is less of a problem for consumers who have greater "risk capital," because they have less to lose from a poor choice. For example, a highly self-confident person might worry less than a vulnerable, insecure person who chooses a brand that peers think isn't cool.

Mass customization describes the personalization of products and services for individual customers at a mass-production price.⁵⁹ This product involvement strategy applies to a wide range of products and services, from newspaper Web sites that allow readers to choose which sections of the paper they want to see, to Dell computers that you can configure, to Levi's blue jeans that have a right leg one inch shorter than a left leg to fit an asymmetrical body (this is more common than you think).⁶⁰ Mars Snackfood USA

Figure 5.4 FIVE TYPES OF PERCEIVED RISK

	BUYERS MOST SENSITIVE TO RISK	PURCHASES MOST SUBJECT TO RISK
MONETARY RISK	Risk capital consists of money and property. Those with relatively little income and wealth are most vulnerable.	High-ticket items that require substantial expenditures are most subject to this form of risk.
FUNCTIONAL RISK	Risk capital consists of alternative means of performing the function or meeting the need. Practical consumers are most sensitive.	Products or services whose purchase and use requires the buyer's exclusive commitment are most sensitive.
PHYSICAL RISK	Risk capital consists of physical vigor, health, and vitality. Those who are elderly, frail, or in ill health are most vulnerable.	Mechanical or electrical goods (such as vehicles or flammables), drugs and medical treatment, and food and beverages are most sensitive.
SOCIAL RISK	Risk capital consists of self-esteem and self-confidence. Those who are insecure and uncertain are most sensitive.	Socially visible or symbolic goods, such as clothes, jewelry, cars, homes, or sports equipment are most subject to social risk.
PSYCHO-LOGICAL RISK	Risk capital consists of affiliations and status. Those lacking self-respect or attractiveness to peers are most sensitive.	Expensive personal luxuries that may engender guilt, durables, and services whose use demands self-discipline or sacrifice are most sensitive.

introduced M&M's Faces to encourage consumers to bond with its chocolates: At mymms.com, you can upload a photo and order a batch of M&Ms with a face and personal message printed on the candy shell.

When a consumer is highly involved with a specific product, this is the Holy Grail for marketers because it means he or she exhibits **brand loyalty**: Repeat purchasing behavior that reflects a conscious decision to continue buying the same brand.⁶² Note that this definition states that the consumer not only buys the brand on a regular basis, but that he or she also has a strong positive attitude toward it rather than simply buying it out of habit. In fact, we often find that a brand-loyal consumer has more than simply a positive attitude; frequently he or she is passionate about the product. "True-blue" users react more vehemently when a company alters, redesigns, or (God forbid) eliminates a favorite brand. One simple test to find out if you're brand loyal: If the store is temporarily out of your favorite brand, will you buy a different product or hold off until you can get your first choice?

Although everyone wants to cultivate brand-loyal customers, there is a wrinkle that sometimes confounds even the most effective marketers. We often engage in *brand switching*, even if our current brand satisfies our needs. When researchers for British brewer Bass Export studied the U.S. beer market, they discovered that many drinkers have a repertoire of two to six favorite brands rather than one clear favorite.⁶³

Sometimes, it seems we simply like to try new things; we crave variety as a form of stimulation or to reduce boredom. **Variety-seeking**, the desire to choose new alternatives over more familiar ones, even influences us to switch from our favorite products to ones we like less! This can occur even before we become *satiated*, or tired, of our favorite. Research supports the idea that we are willing to trade enjoyment for variety because the unpredictability *itself* is rewarding.⁶⁴

We're especially likely to look for variety when we are in a good mood, or when there isn't a lot of other stuff going on.⁶⁵ So, even though we have favorites, we still like to sample other possibilities. However, when the decision situation is ambiguous, or when there is little information about competing brands, we tend to opt for the safe choice.

Message Involvement

It started with Jay Z's celebrated campaign to promote his autobiographical *Decoded* book. The agency Droga5 created a national scavenger hunt when it hid all 320 pages of the book (mostly blown-up versions) in outdoor spots in 13 cities that somehow related to the text on each page (e.g. on cheeseburger wrappers in New York). Coldplay borrowed a page from this book more recently to promote its album *Ghost Stories*. The band hid lyric sheets inside ghost stories in libraries around the world and gave out clues on Twitter.⁶⁶ This represents an emerging way to engage consumers: In **alternate reality games (ARGs)**, thousands of people participate in a fictional story or competition to solve a mystery.

As these novel scavenger hunts illustrate, media vehicles possess different qualities that influence our motivation to pay attention to what they tell us, known as **message involvement**. Print is a *high-involvement medium* (whether it appears on a "dead tree" or in an e-book). The reader actively processes the information and (if desired) he or she is able to pause and reflect on it before turning the page.⁶⁷ In contrast, television is a *low-involvement medium* because it requires a passive viewer who exerts relatively little control (remote-control "zipping" notwithstanding) over content.

TV's passive nature explains why advertisers try to place their ads in shows such as *American Idol* that engage viewers; they want to increase the likelihood their audience will pay attention when their messages come on the screen. Research evidence indicates that a viewer who is more involved with a television show will respond more positively to commercials he or she sees during that show, and that these spots will have a greater chance to influence purchase intentions.⁶⁹ In fact, some messages (including really well-made advertisements) are so involving that they trigger a stage of **narrative transportation**, where people become immersed in the storyline. One recent study showed that people who are feeling lucky engage in this process when they look at an advertisement for a lottery; once immersed, it is hard to distract them from the message.⁷⁰ Not a great thing for compulsive gamblers, but a powerful effect nonetheless.

Although consumers' involvement levels with a product message vary, marketers do not have to simply sit back and hope for the best. If they are aware of some basic factors that increase or decrease attention, they can take steps to increase the likelihood that product information will get through. A marketer can boost a person's motivation to process relevant information via one or more of the following techniques:⁷¹

- **Use novel stimuli, such as unusual cinematography, sudden silences, or unexpected movements, in commercials.** When a British firm called Egg Banking introduced a credit card to the French market, its ad agency created unusual commercials to make people question their assumptions. One ad stated, "Cats always land on their paws," and then two researchers in white lab coats dropped a kitten off a rooftop—never to see it again (animal rights activists were not amused).⁷²
- **Use prominent stimuli, such as loud music and fast action, to capture attention.** In print formats, larger ads increase attention. Also, viewers look longer at colored pictures than at black-and-white ones.
- **Include celebrity endorsers.** As we'll see in Chapter 8, people process more information when it comes from someone they admire or at least know about, whether Michael Jordan, Bill Gates, or maybe even Kim Kardashian.

Net Profit



The Nielsen research company wanted to see if the social media activity people participated in while they watched a TV show related

to how involved they were with the action in the program. Sure enough, when they hooked up 300 people to brain monitors as they watched prime-time TV shows in a 2015 study, they found a strong relationship with the number of messages on *Twitter* during the same segments on these shows when they aired on live TV. Nielsen concludes that *Twitter* chatter is an accurate indicator of the overall audience's interest in a show, right down to the specific scene. In a separate study Nielsen also found that the volume of tweets about new shows before they launch can predict which premieres will attract the largest audiences.⁶⁸

A novel or unexpected image can heighten involvement, especially for a less-than-thrilling business like an optician.

Source: luerzersarchive.net.



- **Provide value that customers appreciate.** Charmin bathroom tissue set up public toilets in Times Square that hordes of grateful visitors used. Thousands more people (evidently with time on their hands) visited the brand's Web site to view the display.⁷³
- **Invent new media platforms to grab attention.** Procter & Gamble printed trivia questions and answers on its Pringles snack chips with ink made of blue or red food coloring, and a company called Speaking Roses International patented a technology to laser-print words, images, or logos on flower petals.⁷⁴ An Australian firm creates hand stamps that nightclubs use to identify paying customers; the stamps include logos or ad messages so partiers' hands become an advertising platform.⁷⁵

Product involvement often depends on the situation we're in. The Charmin toilet tissue brand sponsors a Web site, appropriately named SitOrSquat.com. The site helps travelers find the cleanest public restrooms wherever they happen to be. The brand manager explains, "Our goal is to connect Charmin with innovative conversations and solutions as a brand that understands the importance of bringing the best bathroom experience to consumers, even when they're away from home." According to Charmin, SitOrSquat lists over 52,000 toilets in 10 countries.

Source: Courtesy of P&G/Charmin.



- **Encourage viewers to think about actually using the product.** If a person can imagine this, he or she is more likely to want to obtain the real thing. Research shows that even subtle cues in an advertisement can encourage this mental rehearsal. One simple example is orienting an image of a cup with its handle to the right so that (for a right-handed person) it matches the dominant hand and facilitates mental stimulation.⁷⁶
- **Create spectacles where the message is itself a form of entertainment.** In the early days of radio and television, ads literally were performances; show hosts integrated marketing messages into the episodes. Today live advertising that features attention-grabbing events called **spectacles** is making a comeback as marketers try harder and harder to captivate jaded consumers:⁷⁷ Axe body products sponsored a posh Hamptons (New York) nightclub for the whole season; it became The Axe Lounge, sporting branding on the DJ booth and menu and Axe products in the restrooms.

Situational Involvement

Situational involvement describes engagement with a store, Web site, or a location where people consume a product or service. One way to increase this kind of involvement is to personalize the messages shoppers receive at the time of purchase. For example, a few marketers tailor the recommendations they give shoppers in a store based on what they picked up from a shelf. At some Dunkin' Donuts locations, a person who orders a morning coffee sees an ad at the cash register that pushes hash browns or breakfast sandwiches. Many retailers and event planners today focus on enhancing customers' experiences in stores, dealerships, and stadiums. Industry insiders refer to this as a "butts-in-seats" strategy. That's why some fans who attend Atlanta Falcons football games get visited by a cheerleader in the stands for a photo op, and also why Chrysler is ramping up its efforts to get people to test drive cars at dealerships and auto shows. As the head of the car company's "experiential marketing unit" explained, "We know a physical experience with a vehicle is a great way to allow people to try it out and move up on their consideration list."⁷⁸



Net Profit



Would you pay hard-earned money to watch *other* people play videogames? If you answer yes, you're part of the booming **e-sports** phenomenon.

These sports boast stars, uniforms, and rivalries, but the players are clicking their mouses rather than swinging their bats. In a world championship game in Seoul, 40,000 fans packed a stadium built for the soccer World Cup to cheer on their favorite League of Legends team.⁷⁹

E-Sports is a rapidly growing phenomenon around the world.

Source: Jean Chung/The New York Times/Redux.

MyLab Marketing

To complete the problems with the , go to EOC Discussion Questions in the MyLab as well as additional Marketing Metrics questions only available in MyLab Marketing.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

1. Products can satisfy a range of consumer needs.

Marketers try to satisfy consumers' needs, but the reason any product is purchased can vary widely. The identification of consumer motives is an important step to ensure that a product will meet the appropriate need(s). Traditional approaches to consumer behavior have focused on the abilities of products to satisfy rational needs (utilitarian motives), but hedonic motives (such as the need for exploration or fun) also guide many purchase decisions. Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs demonstrates that the same product can satisfy different needs.

2. Consumers experience different kinds of motivational conflicts that can impact their purchase decisions.

Motivation refers to the processes that lead people to behave as they do. It occurs when a need is aroused that the consumer wishes to satisfy. A goal has *valence*, which means that it can be positive or negative. We direct our behavior toward goals we value positively; we are motivated to *approach* the goal and to seek out products that will help us to reach it. However, we may also be motivated to *avoid* a negative outcome rather than achieve a positive outcome.

3. Consumers experience a range of affective responses to products and marketing messages.

Affective responses can be mild (evaluations), moderate (moods), or strong (emotions). Marketers often try to elicit a positive emotional response via advertising or other communication channels so that consumers form a bond (or lovemark) with their offering. A lot of the content on social media reflects affective responses that people post, so these platforms are a rich source of information for marketers to gauge how consumers feel about their brands.

4. The way we evaluate and choose a product depends on our degree of involvement with the product, the marketing message, or the purchase situation.

Product involvement can range from low where consumers make purchase decisions based on inertia, to high where they form strong bonds with favorite brands (cult products). Marketing strategies also need to consider consumers' extent of engagement with the messages about their products and the environments in which consumption of these products occur.

KEY TERMS

Affect, 180	Expectancy theory, 174	Moods, 180
Alternate reality games (ARGs), 191	Goal, 173	Motivation, 173
Approach–approach conflict, 176	Guilt, 184	Narrative transportation, 191
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REVIEW

- 5-1 What is *motivation* and why is this idea so important to marketers?
- ★ 5-2 Describe three types of motivational conflicts. Cite an example of each from a current marketing campaign.
- 5-3 Explain the difference between a need and a want.
- 5-4 What is *cognitive dissonance*?
- ★ 5-5 What are some of the key problems with Maslow's hierarchy of needs?
- ★ 5-6 List three types of perceived risk, and give an example of each.
- 5-7 What is the difference between a *mood* and an *emotion*?
- 5-8 What is *mood congruency* and how do advertisers use it?
- 5-9 What is it about a cult product that allows a higher price point?
- 5-10 What are some strategies marketers can use to increase consumers' involvement with their products?

CONSUMER BEHAVIOR CHALLENGE

■ DISCUSS

- 5-11** Does money buy happiness? Why or why not?
- 5-12** Many consumers today seem to be obsessed with monitoring their emotions. They post about their feelings, track their sleep patterns, and fret about how often they're "liked" on social media. Should happiness be quantified?
- 5-13** Crisis, fear, and guilt are very common themes in marketing and advertising. Humanitarian disasters are the backdrops favored by charities to elicit donations. Fear of burglary or weather damage fuels home and contents insurance marketing. Gyms rely on our guilt about putting on a few pounds over the winter months. These are all dominant emotions—should marketers use these emotions as integral parts of their marketing campaigns?
- 5-14** A group of psychologists argued that we need to revise Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs. They propose we should delete "self-actualization" from the pinnacle and

replace it with "parenting." Right below this peak, they added "mate retention" and "mate acquisition." They claim that too many people see Maslow's triangle as "aspirational"—a description of what fulfilled individuals "should" do—rather than as an explanation of how human motivation actually works. Their perspective is evolutionary; if the only purpose of art, music, and literature is self-fulfillment, how does that contribute to the survival of the species? One of the proponents of this view observes, "If you are a good poet or a good musician, there is a reproductive payoff: women are attracted to men with these abilities. What a man is saying when he is playing his guitar up there is 'look at my good genes.'" What do you think—do our motivations to buy, have, and be ultimately come down to survival of our gene pool?⁸⁰

- 5-15** The chapter discusses a study that says our moods actually get worse when we spend a lot of time on Facebook because we feel like we're wasting our time. Do you agree?

■ APPLY

- 5-16** Our online behaviors also can satisfy needs at different levels of Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs, especially when we participate in social networks such as Facebook. Web-based companies can build loyalty if they keep these needs in mind when they design their offerings:
- We satisfy physiological needs when we use the Web to research topics such as nutrition or medical questions.
 - The Web enables users to pool information and satisfy safety needs when they call attention to bad practices, flawed products, or even dangerous predators.
 - Profile pages on Facebook let users define themselves as individuals.
 - Online communities, blogs, and social networks provide recognition and achievement to those who cultivate a reputation for being especially helpful or expert in some subject.
 - Users can seek help from others and connect with people who have similar tastes and interests.
 - Access to invitation-only communities provides status.
 - Spiritually based online communities can provide guidance to troubled people.⁸¹

Interview people you know about their motivations to participate in social media. Ask them to provide a list of the platforms they access most, then for each probe about their reasons to visit these. What needs do these sites appear to satisfy? How might these insights help you to devise ideas for new social media products?

- 5-17** Interview members of a celebrity fan club. Describe their level of involvement with the "product," and devise some marketing strategies to reach this group.

- 5-18** Crowdfunding is a relatively new frontier for marketing and consumer behavior. The main feature of this type of business arrangement and its related marketing revolves around attracting a sufficient number of interested backers to fund the project. The reward for involvement is the eventual delivery of the product and any rewards or additional features that are either included as a reward tier for larger contributions or "unlocked" once the basic funding figure has been exceeded. However, the relationship between the developers of the product and the backers is no longer a simple case of gathering pre-sales funding to validate the demand for the product. Increasingly, backers are involved in the actual development and direction that the product takes. The project developer responds to the requirements of the backers; after all, it is their funds that underpin the financial viability of the whole project. Crowdfunding certainly shortens the development cycle for new products, but it is developing far beyond the original idea of peer-to-peer lending or involvement.⁸²

Research the development of crowdfunding across two or more crowdfunding platforms. How has the development and launch of products been influenced by the involvement of the customers or backers? How has the product been marketed? Has the product, once launched, featured the involvement of backers in

the marketing messages? In your view, is this backer involvement and influence a feature that is likely to continue to develop? What challenges will marketers

face in the future both during the project crowdfunding phase and the eventual launch of the product on the market?

Case Study

HAS THE DEATH OF THE WATCH BEEN GREATLY EXAGGERATED? APPLE GETS INTO THE GAME

It used to be that putting on a watch was just a standard part of getting dressed in the morning. How could you hope to move successfully throughout your day, making it to appointments on time, if you weren't wearing a watch on your wrist to let you know what time it is?

Today however, we're surrounded by technology devices at work, home, and even away from home that readily display the time of day. The outcome? Many have come to view the personal watch as an unnecessary device. As a result, the watch industry has been struggling to find ways to remain relevant, searching for the key to how they can motivate consumers to purchase a time-keeping device that many consider redundant with the desktops, laptops, tablets, and cellphones to which they are so connected.

As industry analysts have pointed out, watches may actually be "superfluous" and there are claims that "telling time is secondary today." And even for those more diehard consumers who still wear a watch, according to Marshall Cohen, chief industry analyst in New York at the NPD Group, "there's no practical need for any watch-wearing holdouts to pay a lot for a timepiece."

Apple says, not true! It believes that the death of the watch has been greatly exaggerated and in response, the company recently introduced the Apple Watch. These devices range in price from \$350 to more than \$10,000. The new watches, far from simply telling the time, are actually mini-computers that allow the wearer to check and send messages, surf the Internet, monitor heart rate, and pay in a store.

The watches' introduction has been both praised and criticized. Some point to Apple's ability to interest consumers in any number of technology devices and believe that the Apple Watch will be yet another success story for the company. An early reviewer, *Wall Street Journal's* Geoffrey Fowler, believes that his dependence on other devices has decreased since putting on the Apple Watch and that it's helped him to be more focused. But others cite consumers' waning interest in watches in general, the difficulties in functioning with such a small screen, and they wonder who would really be motivated to make the investment in the entry level model, let alone the top of the line, Apple Watch Edition, with an attention-getting price tag of \$17,000!

So what does Apple think will motivate consumers to buy one of these new gadgets? They talk about consumers' need to quickly and subtly get access to information, which is not always possible with a clunkier tablet or cell phone. Tim Bajarin,

Creative Strategies analyst says, "the flexibility of "glanceable information" is more valuable than people realize today." He also mentions that the new watches will offer options for non-verbal communication, tapping a button to send a message, for instance. Apple CEO Tim Cook calls it "the most personal device we've ever created—it's not just with you, it's on you" and claims that it's the most advanced timepiece ever created, period.

Analysts forecast that Apple will ship 7.5 million watches in the months following its introduction. But critics still wonder if consumers can be convinced that there's a real need for the devices. On top of that, there's a potentially saturated market to consider, with 10 million competing smartwatches shipped in the year before Apple's entry into the product category. Another form of competition comes from the established luxury brand watches that may have already cornered the higher end of the market. Proponents of luxury watches believe that Apple can't match their unique qualities—prestige, resale value, their ability to be passed down as an heirloom, exclusivity, and a less obtrusive look which may be safer for the wearer.

While blogger John Gruber commented on a recent podcast: "I still have no idea why I would want to wear it," early adopters of the Apple Watches and others who believe in the power of Apple to succeed were not surprised by recent announcements from the company about an upgraded operating system and improvements that will make the watches' apps work even better.

So, who knows how this story will turn out—will Apple be the game-changer that played a significant role in how we think about the evolution of the personal watch or will it be seen as having momentarily misstepped into an industry whose death was already a foregone conclusion?

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- CS 5.1** Discuss the possible reasons to buy a watch today. Connect each motivation you identify with an appropriate motivational theory from the chapter.
- CS 5.2** What does Apple really believe will motivate consumers to purchase the Apple Watch? Are there different motivations at the low versus high (luxury version) price point?
- CS 5.3** How do marketers of watches use marketing and advertising to motivate consumers to buy them? Give specific examples.

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MyLab Marketing

Go to the Assignments section of your MyLab to complete these writing exercises.

- 5.19** The basic lesson of Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs is that we must first satisfy basic needs before we progress up the ladder (a starving man is not interested in status symbols, friendship, or self-fulfillment). This implies that consumers value different product attributes depending on what is currently available to them. In today's economic environment, the hierarchy helps to explain why many consumers take a closer look at the price and reliability of a product rather than whether it will impress their friends. How do you believe the recession changed the way consumers evaluate products? Do you agree that the priorities many now place on "value-priced" brands is the "new normal," or will our attitudes change as the economy improves?
- 5.20** Our emotional reactions to marketing cues are so powerful that some high-tech companies study mood in small doses (in 1/30 of a second increments) as they analyze people's facial reactions when they see ads or new products. They measure happiness as they look for differences between, for example, a *true smile* (which includes a relaxation of the upper eyelid) and a *social smile* (which occurs only around the mouth). Whirlpool used this technique to test consumers' emotional reactions to a yet-to-be-launched generation of its Duet washers and dryers. The company's goal: To design an appliance that will actually make people happy. Researchers discovered that even though test subjects said they weren't thrilled with some out-of-the-box design options, such as unusual color combinations, their facial expressions said otherwise.⁸³ Does the ability to study our emotional reactions at such a specific level give marketers an unfair advantage?

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Chapter 6 • The Self: Mind, Gender, and Body

Chapter Objectives

When you finish reading this chapter you will understand why:

- 6-1** The self-concept strongly influences consumer behavior.
- 6-2** Products often define a person's self-concept.
- 6-3** Gender identity is an important component of a consumer's self-concept.
- 6-4** The way we think about our bodies (and the way our culture tells us we should think) is a key component of self-esteem.
- 6-5** Every culture dictates certain types of body decoration or mutilation.



Source: gpointstudio/Shutterstock.

Lisa is trying to concentrate on the report her client expects by five o'clock. She has worked hard to maintain this important account for the firm, but today she is distracted thinking about her date with Eric last night. Although things seemed to go OK, she couldn't shake the feeling that Eric regards her more as a friend than as a potential romantic partner. As she leafs through *Glamour* and *Cosmopolitan* during her lunch hour, Lisa is struck by all the articles that offer tips on how to become more attractive by dieting, exercising, and wearing sexy clothes. She begins to feel depressed as she looks at the svelte models in the many advertisements for perfumes, apparel, and makeup. Each woman is more glamorous and beautiful than the last. Surely they've had "adjustments"; women simply don't look that way in real life. Then again, it's unlikely that Eric could ever be mistaken for Brad Pitt on the street. Still, in her down mood, Lisa

actually thinks that maybe she should look into cosmetic surgery. Even though she's never considered herself unattractive, maybe if she got a new nose or removed that mole on her cheek she'd feel better about herself. Who knows, she might look so good she'll get up the nerve to submit a photo to that Web site Tinder that everyone's talking about. But on second thought, is Eric even worth it?

OBJECTIVE 6-1

The self-concept strongly influences consumer behavior.

The Self

Are you what you buy? Lisa isn't the only person who feels that her physical appearance and possessions affect her "value" as a person. We choose many products, from cars to cologne, because

we want to highlight or hide some aspect of the self. In this chapter, we'll focus on how consumers' feelings about themselves shape their consumption practices, particularly as they strive to fulfill their society's expectations about how a male or female should look and act.

Does the Self Exist?

Most of us can't boast of coming close to Katy Perry's 66 million followers on Twitter, but many of us do have hundreds of followers, in addition to legions of Facebook friends.¹ The explosion of these and other social networking services enables everyone to focus on himself or herself and share mundane or scintillating details about life with anyone who's interested (*why* they are interested is another story!).

An emphasis on the unique nature of the self is much greater in Western societies.³ Many Eastern cultures stress the importance of a **collective self**, where a person derives his or her identity in large measure from a social group. Both Eastern and Western cultures believe that the self divides into an inner, private self and an outer, public self. Where cultures differ is in terms of which part they see as the "real you"; the West tends to subscribe to an independent understanding of the self, which emphasizes the inherent separateness of each individual.

Non-Western cultures, in contrast, tend to focus on an interdependent self where we define our identities largely by our relationships with others.⁴ For example, a Confucian perspective stresses the importance of "face": others' perceptions of the self and maintaining one's desired status in their eyes. One dimension of face is *mien-tzu*, the reputation one achieves through success and ostentation. Some Asian cultures developed explicit rules about the specific garments and even colors that certain social classes and occupations were allowed to display. These traditions live on today in Japanese style manuals that set out detailed instructions for dressing and how to address people of differing status.⁵ That orientation is a bit at odds with such Western conventions as "casual Friday," which encourages employees to express their unique selves through dress (at least short of muscle shirts and flip-flops).

Self-Concept

The **self-concept** summarizes the beliefs a person holds about his or her own attributes and how he or she evaluates the self on these qualities. Although your overall self-concept may be positive, there certainly are parts of it you evaluate more positively than others. For example, Lisa feels better about her professional identity than she does about her feminine identity.

The self-concept is a complex structure. We describe attributes of self-concept along such dimensions as *content* (e.g., facial attractiveness versus mental aptitude), *positivity* (i.e., self-esteem), *intensity and stability* over time, and *accuracy* (i.e., the degree to which one's self-assessment corresponds to reality).⁶ As we'll see later in this chapter, consumers' self-assessments can be quite distorted, especially with regard to their physical appearance. In addition, our own estimates of how much we change over time vary as well: A recent study that included both young and old people asked more than 19,000 respondents about their preferences in the past (foods, vacations, hobbies, and bands) and also to predict how their tastes will change in the future. Regardless of age, people acknowledged that their prior choices had changed quite a bit over time, but they still tended to predict that they would not change as they got older.⁷

A person's self-concept is a work in progress. Some parts are fairly stable, but each of us modifies some elements of it as we make our way through life—and particularly as we discover new ideas, social groups we admire, and yes, images we receive from the culture around us that endorse certain types of people over others. Each element that contributes to our self-concept is an **identity**. One way to define identity is "any category label with which a consumer self-associates that is amenable to a clear picture of what a person in that category looks like, thinks, feels and does." Some of these identities are pretty stable

Net Profit



Today it seems natural to think of ourselves as potential celebs waiting for our 15 minutes of fame (as the pop icon Andy Warhol once predicted).

The Internet supplies **microfame** for many people like the blogger Perez Hilton and the buxom singer Tila Tequila. Indeed some analysts propose that microfame has morphed into **nanofame** as the glare of the internet spotlight shines brighter and increasingly faster—you may (or may not!) remember the temporarily famous "Alex from Target" (a cashier turned overnight heartthrob on Twitter) or "Left Shark" who was an awkward backup dancer during Katy Perry's 2015 Super Bowl performance. One easy avenue to nanofame: The Vine platform that lets users share 6-second videos. It boasts more than 200 people who have more than a million followers each.²

Marketing Pitfall



A word to the wise: Corporate recruiters often complain about students who show up for job interviews in sloppy or revealing clothing; these applicants failed to “read the memo” about which role they’re expected to play in professional settings! Opportunities for impression management abound, and this includes how you act at business dinners or networking events. Indeed researchers found evidence of an **imbibing idiot bias**: Even when they are not actually impaired, people who simply *hold* an alcoholic beverage are perceived to be less intelligent than those who do not. Job candidates who ordered wine during an interview held over dinner were viewed as less intelligent and less hireable than candidates who ordered soda. Ironically, the job candidates themselves believed that ordering wine rather than soda helped them to appear more intelligent!¹⁸

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(e.g., mother, African American), whereas other identities are more temporary and likely to change (e.g., Libertarian, college student, Prius driver).⁸

As we’ll see in Chapter 7, marketers try hard to understand which consumers adopt certain identities and then develop products and messages that meet the needs of people who link themselves to a given identity. So for example a person who sees herself as environmentally responsible is more likely than someone who doesn’t think much about that to drive a Prius hybrid vehicle. “Green” products are more likely to get that person’s attention.

Self-Esteem

Self-esteem refers to the positivity of a person’s self-concept. People with low self-esteem expect that they will not perform very well, and they will try to avoid embarrassment, failure, or rejection. When Sara Lee developed a new line of snack cakes, for example, researchers found that consumers low in self-esteem preferred portion-controlled snack items because they felt they lacked self-control.⁹ In contrast, a more recent study found that individuals who are made to feel powerful spend more money on themselves (“because I’m worth it!”), whereas those who experience a feeling of powerlessness spend more on others than on themselves.¹⁰

How do marketers influence self-esteem? Exposure to ads such as the ones Lisa checked out can trigger a process of **social comparison**, in which the person tries to evaluate her appearance by comparing it to the people depicted in these artificial images.¹¹ This is a basic human tendency, and many marketers tap into our need for benchmarks when they supply idealized images of happy, attractive people who just happen to use their products. An ad campaign for Clearasil is a good example. In one typical ad, two teenage boys enter a kitchen where a 40-ish mother is mixing something in a bowl. When her son leaves the room, his friend hits on Mom. The ad’s tagline: “Clearasil may cause confidence.”

In a study that illustrates the social comparison process, female college students who were exposed to beautiful women in advertisements afterward expressed lowered satisfaction with their own appearance, as compared to other participants who did not view ads with attractive models.¹² Another study reported that young women alter their perceptions of their own body shapes and sizes after they watch as little as 30 minutes of TV programming.¹³ Researchers report similar findings for men.¹⁴ This process even operates when we decide how much to eat: A study found that people who were served food by a server who was either fat or thin chose different portion sizes.¹⁵

Real and Ideal Selves

When a consumer compares some aspect of himself or herself to an ideal, this judgment influences self-esteem. He or she might ask, “Am I as good-looking as I would like to be?” or “Do I make as much money as I should?” The **ideal self** is a person’s conception of how he or she would like to be, whereas the **actual self** refers to our more realistic appraisal of the qualities we do and don’t have. We choose some products because we think they are consistent with our actual self, whereas we buy others to help us reach an ideal standard. We also often engage in a process of **impression management** in which we work hard to “manage” what others think of us; we strategically choose clothing and other products that will show us off to others in a good light.¹⁶

Impression management applies to all sorts of behaviors, from professional contexts and dating to markers of religious observance. For example, an increasing number of Islamic men in Egypt have a *zebibah* (Arabic for “raisin”)—a dark circle of callused skin or a bump—between the hairline and the eyebrows. It marks the spot where the worshipper repeatedly presses his forehead into the ground during his daily prayers (observant Muslims pray five times a day). Some add prayers so that the bump will become even more pronounced; the owner of the mark thus broadcasts his degree of piousness on his head. As an Egyptian newspaper editor explains, “there is a kind of statement in it. Sometimes as a personal statement to announce that he is a conservative Muslim and sometimes as a way of outbidding others by showing them that he is more religious or to say that they should be like him.”¹⁷